

Crema Italia — Collaboration Standard

Version 1.0 · 2026-07-13 **Source of truth:** this file (`docs/standards/collaboration-standard.md`) in the theme repo. **Companion standards:** Brand Standards v2.0 (look & voice) · Store Operating Standards v1.2 (commerce).

What this document is. The canonical statement of **how we work** — how truth is recorded, who may edit what, and how the human (Steve) and the AI agents (Claude **Code** in this repo, Claude **Cowork** on the OneDrive desktop) stay in sync without drifting. It is the third of three Standards. Brand Standards owns look & voice; Store Operating Standards owns commerce; this owns the *operating protocol between us*. Governance decisions go here so they stop living scattered in `CLAUDE.md` callouts and in the log.

1. The two kinds of durable writing — don't confuse them

- A **Standard** tells you **what is true now**. Always current; old versions are replaced. Read it to know how things work. → Brand Standards, Store Operating Standards, this Collaboration Standard.
- A **Log** tells you **what changed, when, and why**. Only grows; never overwritten. Read it to reconstruct history. → `CLAUDE.md` §9 (Code's local ledger) and `Coordination/DECISIONS_LOG.md` (the cross-surface ledger).

The rule for every decision: (1) update the relevant **Standard** to reflect the new truth, and (2) add one dated line to the **Log** recording that it happened. (This generalizes the older brand "current-on-edit" rule to all three Standards.)

2. Three Standards, by kind of truth

Kind of truth	Standard	Answers
How the store looks & speaks	Brand Standards	color, type, voice, logo
How the store buys & sells	Store Operating Standards	pricing, shelves, discounts, fulfilment
How we work	Collaboration Standard (this)	lanes, source-of-truth model, editing protocol, sessions

3. Source vs render — the anti-drift principle (LOCKED, Option A, 2026-07-13)

The failure we are engineering out: a document that is both a machine's build authority **and** a human's reference tends to exist in two editable copies, which drift (this happened — a retired build Prompt and

CLAUDE.md disagreed, and the wrong one was trusted).

The principle:

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Separate the *source* from the *render*. There is exactly one editable source of truth per Standard. Every other copy — the human PDF, a Cowork reference in OneDrive — is a *generated, version-stamped, read-only render* of that source.

- **Sources** are canonical, versioned Markdown, and live in the repo (`docs/standards/`). **git** is the **concurrency gate** and the tamper-evident audit trail.
- **Renders** are distributions (PDF for humans; a copy dropped in OneDrive for Cowork). Each is stamped "Rendered from vN — do not edit; source of truth is `docs/standards/...`". A copy in OneDrive is a **render, not a peer**.
- **You only ever edit the source. Renders get regenerated.** Drift becomes structurally impossible.
- This is the same pattern Brand Standards already used internally (HTML source → PDF render); Option A (2026-07-13) elevates it to the governing rule and applies it to **all three** Standards and to the Cowork copies.

4. Lanes & the editing protocol

- **Claude Code owns this repo.** Code is the authority for the theme and for all three Standard *sources*. In any conflict, **Code takes precedence**.
- **Claude Cowork's lane** is the OneDrive `CremaItalia LLC` ops/brand folder (brand asset authoring, operations docs, research). Cowork **reads** Standards as rendered copies; it does **not** edit Standard sources.
- **Editing protocol (LOCKED 2026-07-13):** any edit Steve asks Cowork to make to a repo-owned artifact must be converted into a prompt for Code to apply to the repository. Cowork *proposes*; Code *applies*. This is the valve that keeps the repo the single source of truth — Cowork can draft or suggest, but the canonical write always happens in Code's lane, through git.
- **Brand assets** still flow **Cowork → Code** (Code copies finalized assets in), not the reverse.

5. Two Code sessions, one repo

The "Code owns the repo" rule covers Code vs. Cowork; it does **not** make two concurrent **Code** sessions on the same checkout safe. If two Code sessions may be active at once, each should either (a) work in its own `git worktree`, or (b) if sharing one checkout, commit its own changes promptly at a natural stopping point and never leave work uncommitted while another session may also be writing, and never run broad commands (`git add -A`, `git checkout .`, `git reset --hard`) that could touch the other session's files. To redirect a running session, let it finish its current edit, review `git status`/`git diff`, commit only its own files, then pause — never stop it mid-write.

6. Working-tree integrity is Code's lane

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Uncommitted changes, truncation, and `.git/index.lock` are **Code's** concern, not the coordinator's. A stale `index.lock` plus `autocrlf` line-ending warnings can *look* like truncation but usually aren't — verify with `git status --short` (empty = clean) and by checking file tails before sounding any alarm. The scheduled coordinator uses only lock-free, read-only git and does not police the working tree.

7. Connectivity

After a reboot, or if GitHub / Shopify CLI access seems off, run the `reconnect-check` skill before any manual git/Shopify troubleshooting. It is read-only and is **Code's** skill to run. Cowork does not run git or the Shopify CLI; if it suspects a connectivity problem, it flags it to Steve/Code.

8. How this stays honest (enforcement)

1. **One named home per kind of truth** (the three Standards) — no more "is it in the Prompt, §9, or memory?"
 2. **Update-the-Standard-on-change** (§1), with a **version stamp** on every render so drift is visible at a glance.
 3. **A short pointer block** in `CLAUDE.md` — the first thing every Code session reads — naming the three Standards and what belongs in each, so `CLAUDE.md` *points* instead of duplicating (keeping it from growing overweight).
 4. **git history** = the audit trail of who changed which rule when.
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